

Words ending in -el and -al

As is the case with -le, the word endings -el and -al generally do not act as suffixes because they are not changing a root word's meaning or part of speech.

travel

The letter *v* does not have a tail or stick.

camel

The letter *m* does not have a tail or stick.

central

The letter *r* does not have a tail or stick.

local

The letter *c* does not have a tail or stick.

△ The rule

Words ending in -el and -al are often preceded by a letter without a stick or tail (part of the letter reaching high or low).

-el exceptions

angel
bagel
chapel
compel
decibel
gel
gospel
hostel
hotel
model
nickel
parallel
propel
scalpel
snorkel

-al exceptions

acquittal
betrayal
capital
coastal
frugal
fundamental
homicidal
hospital
judgmental
mental
municipal
orbital
petal
portal
verbal

△ Exceptions to the rule

As with words ending in -le, there are a number of exceptions, which end in -el or -al but do not follow this rule.

The -al ending as a suffix

The word ending -al can also be used as a suffix because it can sometimes change the meaning of a root word. Words that end with this suffix are usually nouns or adjectives.

▽ The rule

The -al ending can act as a suffix that attaches to a root word, which can be a whole word or part of a word.

This root word is a noun.

person

Add the suffix.

-al

This is the newly formed adjective.

personal

This root word is a noun.

colony

Add the suffix.

-al

The *y* is replaced with *i* before the suffix is added, resulting in the newly formed adjective.

colonial

Words ending in -ol

On rare occasions, -ol is also used as a word ending. This ending is usually found in nouns and verbs. If in doubt, always check the spelling in a dictionary before using it.

Here are ten nouns and verbs that end with -ol.

aerosol carol
cholesterol alcohol
protocol control
idol pistol
patrol symbol